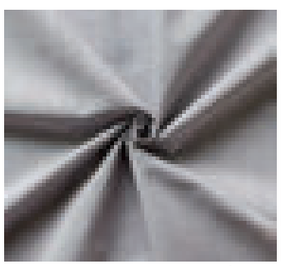


Tentering

vi. **Mercerization:** Mercerization is a chemical finish mostly done on cotton fabrics. The fabric is immersed in 16 – 27 percent of sodium hydroxide and fed between rollers for a specific period of time. Then it is passed on a tendering frame to have specified dimensions. At last it is washed and dried. This process causes the fabric to have increased lustre, improves dying characteristic and strength.



Unmercerized



Mercerized

vii. **Sizing:** Sizing is a process of stiffening materials to yarns or fabrics. Sizes is composed of starch or resin. Starch is applied mostly to cellulose fabrics to improve its luster and to add strength. Resin when applied reacts with the fibre molecules and chemical change occurs in the fibre. Starch is applied to the fabric which then passes between rollers that pad the starch into the fabric and remove excess solution. Thus a fabric with additional stiffness and improved luster is obtained.



Sizing

viii. **Weighting:** Weighting is a process applied to silk fabrics. After removal of gum i.e. degumming, the silk fabric, becomes very soft. To make the silk fabric heavy and stiff the Federal Trade Commission ruled that silk fabric can be given stiffness by addition of 10% stannous chloride a metallic salt. If this 10% exceeds very high the silk fabric tends to crack and split. Weighted silk has body and density but they are not durable and can be damaged by sunlight, air and perspiration.

ix. **Functional finishes** are those which alter, improve or change the behavior or service characteristics of the fabric and produce certain properties. Example: A durable press fabric, a water proof fabric.

x. **Water Proofing:** Water Proof finishes are those that prevent water entering the fabrics. These fabrics do not allow air also to enter and thus not suitable for wearing apparel. Earlier, rubber,

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